



Palo Alto Cortex XSOAR Connector — Credential Provisioning Guide

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Overview

The Crogl Palo Alto Cortex XSOAR connector reads incidents from a Cortex XSOAR 8 tenant's REST API using a single **Standard-type API key**, sent as two headers (`x-xdr-auth-id` and `Authorization`) on every call. There is no OAuth flow and no app registration — one key, generated once in the XSOAR console, covers every endpoint this connector uses.

Generating that key requires access to **Settings & Info > Settings > Integrations > API Keys** in the XSOAR console, which is gated by XSOAR's own role/permission system — whoever generates the key needs a role with permission to manage API keys (an XSOAR role, not a Crogl role). If you're an FDE walking a customer through this live, expect their XSOAR administrator to drive the console while you confirm the resulting values.

IMPORTANT

The console menu paths and label names below are reconstructed from Palo Alto Networks' published Cortex XSOAR 8 API documentation, not confirmed against a live console while writing this guide. Steps that could not be confirmed are marked (**verify against the customer's console**).

NOTE

Cortex XSOAR 8 offers two API key types: **Standard** and **Advanced**. This connector supports **Standard** keys only — Advanced keys require the calling application to compute a per-request `SHA256(api_key + nonce + timestamp)` signature, which Crogl's connector auth model (static headers) cannot produce. Make sure whoever generates the key selects **Standard**, not Advanced, in step 4 below.

What kind of account to create

Cortex XSOAR 8's model is not a separate app registration; it is an **API key** generated from an existing XSOAR user account and explicitly assigned a **role** at creation time, the same way a user's own permissions are role-based. The key's effective permissions are whatever role you assign it — not automatically the permissions of the user who generated it. Assign the narrowest role that can list and read incidents; do not assign an administrator role to this key just because an administrator is the one generating it (**exact predefined role names — e.g. an out-of-the-box read-only analyst role — verify against the customer's console, since role sets are customizable per tenant**).

Permissions to grant

- **Role assigned to the API key.** Chosen from a dropdown of predefined or custom XSOAR roles at key-creation time. It needs, at minimum, permission to view/read incidents. Since this connector is read-only, do not grant an incident-management/write role if a narrower read-only role exists on this tenant.
- **Key type: Standard.** Not a permission in the RBAC sense, but a mandatory choice at creation time — see the note above. Selecting Advanced here will produce a key this connector cannot authenticate with.

There is no separate admin-consent or approval step as in an OAuth flow; the only gate is that the user generating the key must themselves have permission to reach **Settings & Info > Settings > Integrations > API Keys**.

Generating the credential

(Menu path per Palo Alto Networks documentation — verify against the customer's console.)

1. Sign in to the Cortex XSOAR 8 tenant.
2. Open **Settings & Info > Settings > Integrations > API Keys**.
3. Click **New Key**.
4. Choose key type **Standard** (see the note above — do not choose Advanced).
5. Optionally enable **Enable Expiration Date** and set an expiry; XSOAR shows expiration reminders one week and one day before the key lapses. If the customer's security policy requires periodic rotation, set one; otherwise a key with no expiration is simplest to operate.
6. Optionally add a **Comment** describing the key's purpose (e.g. "Crogl connector — read-only").
7. Select the **role** to assign (see [Permissions to grant](#)).
8. Click **Generate**.
9. **Copy the displayed API key value immediately** — this is the value Crogl needs for `api_key`. XSOAR will not show it again once you click Close; if it's lost, generate a new key rather than trying to recover the value.
10. Click **Close**.
11. In the API Keys table, note the **ID** column value for the key you just created — this is the `key_id` value Crogl needs (`x-xdr-auth-id`).

You also need the tenant's **API FQDN**. Per Palo Alto Networks documentation, this is obtained by right-clicking the generated key's row and selecting **View Examples**, which shows a cURL example whose URL contains the host to copy (**this specific right-click interaction was not independently re-confirmed against a live console for this guide — verify against the customer's console**). The FQDN is typically of the form `api-<tenant-id>.paloaltonetworks.com` and is unique per tenant.

Mapping values into Crogl

Three values map to `community/palo-alto-xsoar/connector.json`'s `credential_schema.fields` when creating the connector instance in Crogl:

Crogl field	Where it came from	Notes
<code>api_host</code>	The FQDN copied from the generated key's View Examples cURL example	No <code>https://</code> prefix and no path — just the host (e.g. <code>api-abc123.paloaltonetworks.com</code>). Crogl builds the API base URL <code>https://<api_host>/xsoar/public/v1</code> for you.
<code>key_id</code>	The ID column value for the generated key, in Settings & Info > Settings > Integrations > API Keys	Sent as the <code>x-xdr-auth-id</code> header. Not the key value itself, but treat it as sensitive since it identifies the credential.
<code>api_key</code>	The API key value shown once at generation time	Treat as a password. Never paste it into chat, a ticket, or this document. Crogl sends it as the <code>Authorization</code> header automatically once entered.

Verifying the setup

Right after creating the connector instance in Crogl, confirm the setup:

- **Success:** a simple incident query (e.g. asking Crogl to "show open incidents") returns `HTTP 200` with incident rows. An empty result (`total: 0`) on a filtered query is a valid, successful empty response, not an error.
- **401:** the `api_key` value is wrong, was truncated when copied, or the key has passed its expiration date — generate a new Standard-type key in the XSOAR console and re-enter both `key_id` and `api_key`.
- **403:** the key authenticated, but the **role assigned to it lacks incident-read permission** — widen the assigned role (see [Permissions to grant](#)) rather than re-checking the key value. This is the most common "right credential, wrong permission" case.
- **A signature/authentication error that specifically mentions a nonce or timestamp:** the key was generated as **Advanced** type instead of Standard — this connector cannot use an Advanced key. Generate a new Standard-type key and replace `key_id/api_key`.
- **An error indicating the search endpoint is unsupported in this environment:** per Palo Alto Networks documentation, `/incidents/search` is not supported in multi-tenant XSOAR deployments — if this tenant is a multi-tenant deployment, this is an environment limitation, not a misconfigured credential.
- **Wrong-host / connection error before any XSOAR response:** the `api_host` value is wrong, includes a scheme or path it shouldn't, or doesn't match the tenant the key was generated on — re-copy it from the key's **View Examples** cURL example.